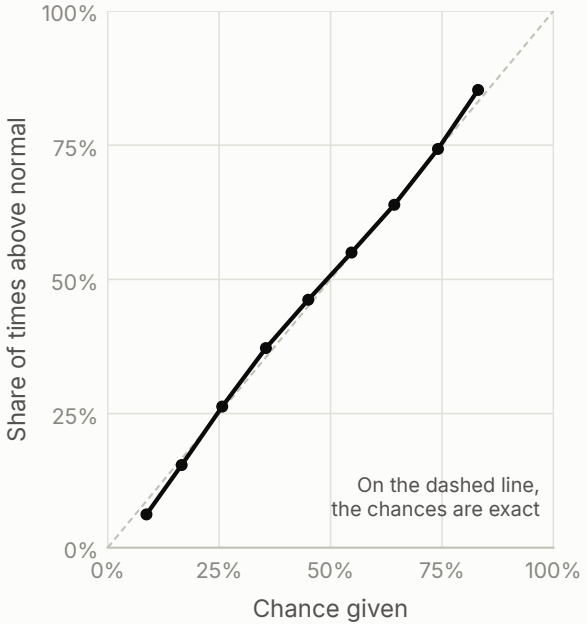
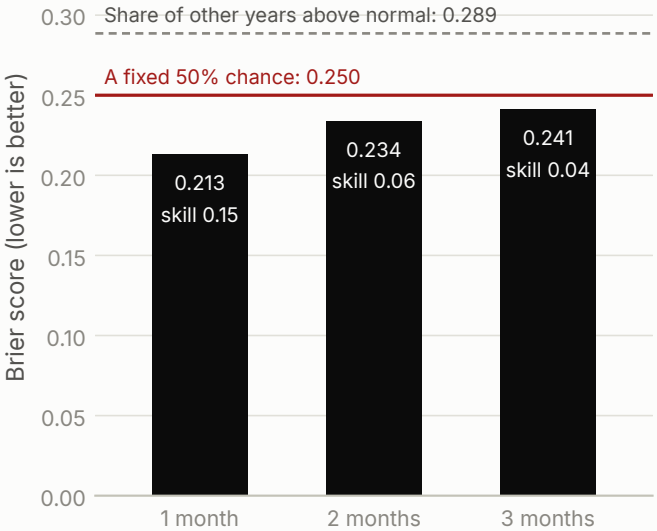
The chances are honest

Held out years, all areas and leads



The skill fades by three months

Brier score of the outlook by lead, and two references



Skill: the Brier skill score against a fixed 50% chance. The share of other years above normal is a weaker reference than it looks, because holding out a year moves it the wrong way. Source: NASA FIRMS, GPM IMERG, MERRA-2, NOAA; analysis: Fire Harmony